

D406

Health Literacy for the Client and Family

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 55-year-old engineer with a master's degree nods through her new heart failure discharge instructions and says she understands. She drives a hybrid car and lives with her husband. What approach should the educator use?

- A. Give her a more technical handout since she is an engineer.
- B. Teach her husband instead.
- C. Use clear language and confirm understanding, as with every patient.
- D. Skip confirming understanding because she has a master's degree.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Why do health literacy experts recommend clear communication with every patient instead of screening to find those with low literacy?

- A. Only older adults have low health literacy.
- B. Screening is illegal.
- C. Most patients have high health literacy.
- D. Limited health literacy is common and often hidden, so it can't be reliably spotted.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

After teaching a father how to give his child an inhaler with a spacer, the nurse is ready to end the visit. The father is a firefighter and the clinic is running 30 minutes behind. What is the best way to check understanding?

- A. Ask him to show how he will give the inhaler at home.
- B. Hand him a detailed booklet.
- C. Ask, "Do you understand?"
- D. Skip it since the clinic is behind.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A clinic's diabetes handout uses words like "glycemic control" and "hypoglycemic episode" in long paragraphs. The clinic is proud of its new color printer. What revision best improves it?

- A. Add more medical detail so it is complete.
- B. Print it in color.
- C. Rewrite it at a college reading level for accuracy.
- D. Rewrite at about a 6th–8th grade level with short sentences, everyday words, and a few key actions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which sentence best follows plain language guidance?

- A. "Adherence to the prescribed regimen is essential."
- B. "Take one pill every morning with food."
- C. "Medication should be administered once daily postprandially."
- D. "Take as directed."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A drug lowers the chance of a stroke over five years from 4 in 100 people to 2 in 100 people. The drug company's ad says it "cuts stroke risk by 50%." The ad won a marketing award. How should the benefit be explained to a patient?

- A. "It prevents strokes."
- B. "It lowers your risk by 4%."
- C. "It cuts your risk by 50%."
- D. "Out of 100 people like you, about 2 fewer would have a stroke over five years."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient's baseline risk is 8 in 100. A treatment reduces relative risk by 25%. What is the risk with treatment?

- A. 7.75 in 100
- B. 6 in 100
- C. 25 in 100
- D. 2 in 100

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A Vietnamese-speaking grandmother arrives with her bilingual 12-year-old grandson, who offers to interpret. The clinic is busy and the grandson is an honor student. What should staff do?

- A. Let the grandson interpret because he is an honor student.
- B. Use a qualified medical interpreter by phone, video, or in person.
- C. Use the grandson only for simple topics.
- D. Speak slowly in English.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is the best interpreter choice for a discussion of a new cancer diagnosis with a patient with limited English?

- A. The patient's adult son.
- B. A bilingual receptionist.
- C. A trained medical interpreter.
- D. A translation app.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A clinic wants patients to take a more active role during short visits. The clinic has a new waiting room aquarium. Which tool best supports this?

- A. Asking patients not to interrupt.
- B. A longer list of instructions.
- C. Ask Me 3: What is my main problem? What do I need to do? Why is it important?
- D. An aquarium to relax patients.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A health system launches a patient portal for test results. Many patients in a rural county have no home internet, and the portal has a sleek new design. What should the system do?

- A.** Offer alternatives like phone or mail, and help patients get access and learn to use the portal.
- B.** Require all patients to use the portal.
- C.** Stop offering results.
- D.** Promote the new design.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12.

A man with early prostate cancer can choose active surveillance or surgery; outcomes are similar. He values staying active and fears side effects. His doctor prefers surgery and has done it for 25 years. What is the best approach?

- A.** Use a decision aid to compare options in plain terms and support his informed choice.
- B.** Surgery is always best for cancer.
- C.** Recommend surgery because the doctor prefers it.
- D.** Tell him to research it on his own.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A 55-year-old engineer with a master's degree nods through her new heart failure discharge instructions and says she understands. ~~She drives a hybrid car and lives with her husband.~~ What approach should the educator use?

Target word: approach for all patients **Decides:** Education level does not guarantee health literacy.

A	Inverted operation	Adds complexity.
B	Camouflage	Leaves out the patient without her request.
C	Correct	Universal precautions apply to all.
D	Absolute language	Education does not guarantee health literacy.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

Why do health literacy experts recommend clear communication with every patient instead of screening to find those with low literacy?

Target word: reverse: rationale **Decides:** Limited literacy is common and hidden.

A	Confusion set	Affects all ages.
B	Absolute language	Not the reason; it is simply unreliable and can shame patients.
C	Inverted operation	The opposite is true.
D	Correct	Universal approach protects everyone.

3. Answer A Concept 2

After teaching a father how to give his child an inhaler with a spacer, the nurse is ready to end the visit. ~~The father is a firefighter and the clinic is running 30 minutes behind.~~ What is the best way to check understanding?

Target word: check understanding **Decides:** Teach-back.

A	Correct	Demonstration confirms understanding.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out any check of understanding.
C	Inverted operation	Yes/no questions don't test learning.
D	Camouflage	Delay does not remove the need.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A clinic's diabetes handout uses words like "glycemic control" and "hypoglycemic episode" in long paragraphs. ~~The clinic is proud of its new color printer.~~ What revision best improves it?

Target word: revise the handout **Decides:** Plain language.

A	Inverted operation	Makes it harder to read.
B	Camouflage	Color doesn't fix reading level.
C	Absolute language	Accuracy does not require a high reading level.
D	Correct	Plain language standards.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

Which sentence best follows plain language guidance?

Target word: reverse: pick plain language **Decides:** Active voice, common words.

A	Confusion set	Vague jargon.
B	Correct	Short, active, and clear.
C	Inverted operation	Passive voice and jargon.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out the actual directions.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A drug lowers the chance of a stroke over five years from 4 in 100 people to 2 in 100 people. The drug company's ad says it "cuts stroke risk by 50%." ~~The ad won a marketing award.~~ How should the benefit be explained to a patient?

Target word: clear risk communication **Decides:** Absolute numbers.

A	Absolute language	Overstates; strokes still occur.
B	Wrong stem number	The baseline risk, not the reduction.
C	Dropped element	Relative risk without the baseline exaggerates.
D	Correct	Absolute risk in natural frequencies.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A patient's baseline risk is 8 in 100. A treatment reduces relative risk by 25%. What is the risk with treatment?

Target word: solve for new risk **Decides:** $8 \times (1 - 0.25)$.

A	Wrong stem number	Subtracts 0.25 as a count instead of taking 25% of 8.
B	Correct	$8 \times 0.75 = 6$.
C	Confusion set	Confuses the relative reduction with absolute risk.
D	Inverted operation	That is the reduction, not the new risk.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A Vietnamese-speaking grandmother arrives with her bilingual 12-year-old grandson, who offers to interpret. The clinic is busy and ~~the grandson is an honor student.~~ What should staff do?

Target word: interpreter choice **Decides:** Qualified interpreter required.

A	Camouflage	Grades don't qualify him.
B	Correct	Ensures accuracy and privacy.
C	Adjacent category	Children should not interpret health information.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out language access.

9. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

Which is the best interpreter choice for a discussion of a new cancer diagnosis with a patient with limited English?

Target word: reverse: pick the best option **Decides:** Trained medical interpreter.

A	Confusion set	Family may filter bad news.
B	Adjacent category	Not trained in medical interpreting.
C	Correct	Accuracy, confidentiality, and neutrality.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out accuracy checks for complex topics.

10. Answer C Concept 6

A clinic wants patients to take a more active role during short visits. ~~The clinic has a new waiting room aquarium.~~ Which tool best supports this?

Target word: tool to empower patients **Decides:** Ask Me 3.

A	Absolute language	Discourages questions.
B	Inverted operation	Adds load without empowering.
C	Correct	Structures patient questions.
D	Camouflage	Irrelevant to participation.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A health system launches a patient portal for test results. Many patients in a rural county have no home internet, and ~~the portal has a sleek new design.~~ What should the system do?

Target word: digital equity **Decides:** Access gaps.

A	Correct	Prevents technology from widening gaps.
B	Absolute language	Excludes people without access.
C	Inverted operation	Removes information instead of increasing access.
D	Camouflage	Design does not solve access.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A man with early prostate cancer can choose active surveillance or surgery; outcomes are similar. He values staying active and fears side effects. His doctor prefers surgery and ~~has done it for 25 years.~~ What is the best approach?

Target word: decision support **Decides:** Close options and clear values.

A	Correct	Shared decision-making.
B	Absolute language	Not always true.
C	Inverted operation	Replaces his values with the doctor's.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out support.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	2	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Universal health literacy precautions	Because limited health literacy is common and cannot be judged by education, job, or appearance, communicate clearly with everyone rather than trying to spot who needs help.	Assuming a college degree or a confident manner means a person understands health information.	A patient who seems educated or who nods along.
2	Teach-back	Ask the person to explain or show in their own words what they need to do; if they cannot, re-teach in a different way — it tests the teaching, not the patient.	Asking “Do you understand?” and accepting a yes.	The end of an education session.
3	Plain language materials	Aim for about a 6th–8th grade reading level, short sentences, active voice, everyday words, and a few key actions per handout.	Adding more detail and medical terms to make a handout more complete.	A draft handout full of jargon or long paragraphs.
4	Communicating numbers and risk	Present risk as natural frequencies and absolute numbers (“2 out of 100”) alongside, or instead of, relative percentages, which can exaggerate an effect.	Reporting only “cuts risk in half” without the baseline.	A relative risk reduction with a small baseline risk.
5	Qualified medical interpreters	Use a trained medical interpreter (in person, phone, or video) for patients with limited English proficiency; do not rely on family members, especially children, for health information.	Letting a bilingual child or relative interpret because it is faster.	A patient with limited English and a family member offering to help.
6	Ask Me 3	Encourage patients to ask: What is my main problem? What do I need to do? Why is it important for me to do this?	Treating patient questions as an interruption or giving a long list of instructions without the “why.”	A tool to help patients take an active role in a visit.
7	Digital health literacy	Portals, apps, and telehealth help only if people can access and use them; check device, internet, and skill, and offer alternatives so technology does not widen gaps.	Assuming everyone can use a patient portal or video visit.	A new app or portal rollout for a mixed population.
8	Shared decision-making and advocacy	When options are close, use decision aids to present choices in plain terms and support the patient’s values; advocate for the choice the informed patient makes.	Presenting only the option the clinician prefers.	More than one reasonable option and a patient with preferences.

Course scope (public description): Health Literacy for the Client and Family helps students recognize the importance of health literacy in overcoming healthcare barriers and creating patient-focused changes through family and patient empowerment. This course demonstrates how education, research, and technology all integrate and serve as a foundation for students as they create effective resources to improve health literacy for patients and families. This course helps students become advocates for their patients and their patients' families. There are no prerequisites for this course.